

Eunsun Kim

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Education	University of California, Los Angeles, Ph.D. in Quantitative Marketing	Expected 2027
	Duke University, M.S. in Economics and Computation	2021
	Seoul National University, M.S. in Quantitative Marketing	2019
	Seoul National University, B.A. in Business <i>summa cum laude</i> ; Minor in Economics	2017
Research Interests	Quantitative Marketing, Empirical Industrial Organization, Reinforcement Learning, Algorithmic Pricing	
Job Market Paper	Following to Lead: Dominant Followership in Sequential Price Competition [Draft] Dominant firms are usually thought to be price leaders: they move first, and rivals follow. Amazon, the dominant platform in online retail, rather follows than leads. Further, despite its dominant market position, Amazon is usually priced at or below the lowest rival price; its distinctiveness lies not in what it charges but in how it responds when a rival moves first. Using synchronized high-frequency cross-platform pricing data, I document three patterns in Amazon's response. First, after a rival raises its price, Amazon is 13 percentage points more likely to raise its own price than it would be otherwise, compared with no detectable response from rivals when Amazon moves first. Second, when Amazon responds, it matches the rival's new price. Third, matched rival price increases remain in place longer than unmatched ones. I call this strategy dominant followership. A sequential Bertrand model modified to break ties in favor of the dominant firm shows why dominant followership can be incentive-compatible: because the dominant firm keeps most demand when prices are comparable, it may prefer matching a rival's higher price to undercutting it. Prices rise above the simultaneous-move Nash equilibrium only when the demand-advantaged firm is also the reliable responder. Using simulation studies, I show that Q-learning algorithms discover dominant followership endogenously: the rival's algorithm learns to initiate higher prices, nearly tripling the market price, yet the dominant firm captures 91 percent of the resulting profit gains. This speaks to the FTC's Project Nessie allegation: individually optimal responses can teach rival algorithms that raising price is profitable, even without explicit coordination. The main insight is that modern algorithmic price competition among asymmetric firms should be modeled as a sequential response process: who responds to a price change matters as much as the price itself.	
Working Papers	Can Consumer AI Discipline Algorithmic Pricing? This project studies whether consumer-side AI shopping agents can weaken dominant-platform pricing power in markets where firms use pricing algorithms. Many consumers begin product search inside a dominant platform and compare only a limited set of alternatives, allowing firms to benefit from search frictions and default position. AI shopping agents can change this environment by searching across platforms, tracking recent price histories, and making price and non-price tradeoffs easier to compare. However, lower search costs need not eliminate platform advantage, because consumers may still value the dominant platform's non-price advantages, such as delivery speed, return convenience, and trust. I model consumer-side AI as lowering search frictions and expanding consumers' consideration sets, which reduces the dominant firm's demand advantage. Starting from a market in which the dominant platform captures a large share of demand, I ask how pricing incentives change as AI agents make consumers more willing to consider rival sellers. The main exercise is a threshold analysis: how much must the dominant firm's demand advantage fall before the dominant-followership mechanism breaks down? I then examine the implications for consumer welfare. The project speaks to a policy question in algorithmic pricing: whether consumer-side AI can discipline dominant platforms through better search, or whether dominant-platform advantages are too persistent for the market to self-correct.	

Honors and Research Grants	AMA-Sheth Consortium Fellow	2026
	NBER Digital Economics and AI Tutorial	2025
	Haring Symposium Fellow	2025
	ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow	2023, 2025
	Price Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation Research Grant	2024
	Grand Prize, Mock Fair Trade Commission Contest, Korea Fair Trade Commission	2017
	Dean's List, Seoul National University Business School	2015, 2016
Presentations	Following to Lead: Dominant Followership in Sequential Price Competition	
	Industrial Organization Proseminar, Department of Economics, UCLA	2025, 2026
	World Congress of the Econometric Society (ESWC)	2025
	ISMS Marketing Science Conference	2025
	Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference	2025
Discussions	Haring Symposium	2025
	California Quantitative Marketing Ph.D. Student Conference	2023, 2024
Teaching Experience	Teaching Assistant, UCLA Anderson School of Management	2022–present
	Customer Assessment and Analytics (MBA elective), Brett Hollenbeck, Robert Zeithammer	
	Data and Decisions (MFE course), H. Tai Lam	
	Statistical Foundations for Data Analytics (MSBA course), Peter Rossi	
	Teaching Assistant, Department of Computer Science, Duke University	2021
	Everything Data	
	Graduate Assistant, Center for Data and Visualization Sciences, Duke University	2020
	Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University Business School	2018–2019
	Data-Driven Marketing Analytics	
	Marketing Management	
Past Employment	Mobile Market Research Team, LG Display	2017
	Intern, Corporate Law Team, Barun Law LLC	2015
Programming	Python, R, MATLAB, C++, L ^A T _E X	
Selected Coursework	University of California, Los Angeles	
	Theory in Marketing, Robert Zeithammer	
	Theory of the Firm and Consumer, Ichiro Obara	
	Game Theory and Information Economics, Moritz Meyer-ter-Vehn	
	Advanced Econometrics II, Rosa Matzkin	
	Econometrics III, Rosa Matzkin	
	Advanced Econometrics III, Denis Chetverikov	
	Methods Econometrics, Peter Rossi	
	Econometrics I, Jinyong Hahn	
	Quantitative Research in Marketing, Brett Hollenbeck and Elisabeth Honka	
	Industrial Organization, Price Policy, and Regulation, John Asker, Martin Hackmann, and Will Rafey	
	Applied Analysis of Behavioral Research, Stephen Spiller	
	Duke University	
	Computational Microeconomics, Vincent Conitzer	
	Computer Vision, Carlo Tomasi	
	Theory and Algorithms for Machine Learning, Cynthia Rudin	
	Probabilistic Machine Learning, Eric B. Laber	
	Bayesian and Modern Statistics, Olanrewaju Akande	
	High-Dimensional Data Analysis, Paul Bendich	
Extracurricular	Certified Yoga Instructor, CorePower Yoga	

REFERENCES

For letters of recommendation, please contact amy.corrales@anderson.ucla.edu.

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